



Higher Education for Students with Intellectual Disability: Profiles of Effective Practice

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Think College National Coordinating Center

Federally funded since 2010 to provide coordination, training and technical assistance to any college or university who wants to establish or improve postsecondary education opportunities to students with intellectual disability on their campus.

www.thinkcollege.net



Think College National Coordinating Center is a project of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, and is funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education, US Dept. of Education. Grant # P407B100002

College Programs for Students with ID

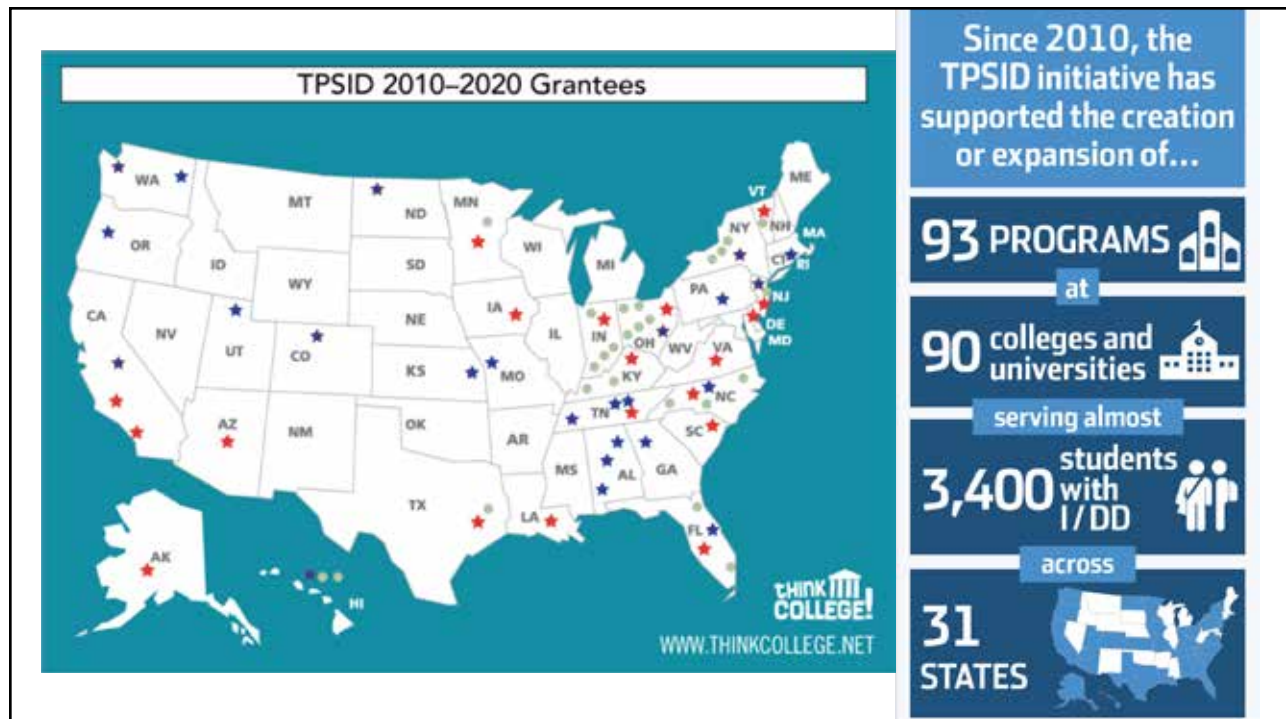
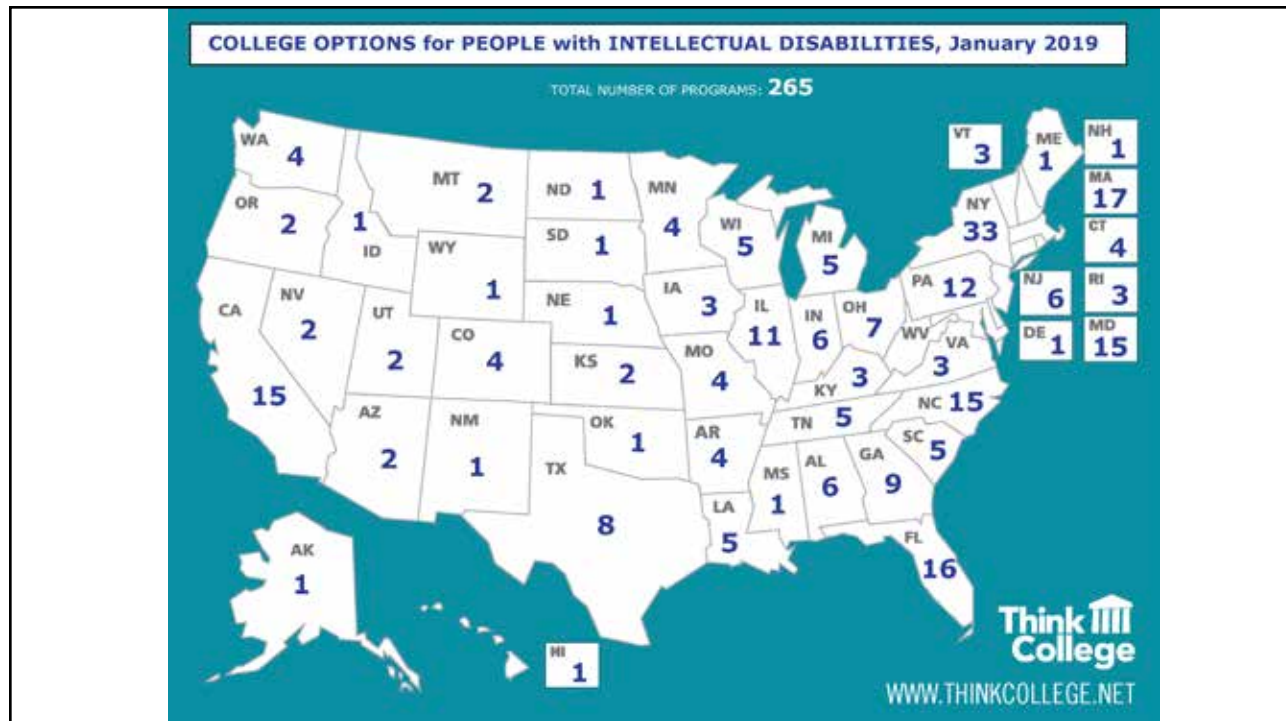
- Have alternative admissions process & requirements
- Accept students who are non-degree seeking
- Vary in length – most are 2 YR, some 4YR
- Vary in level of inclusion
- Established course of study that leads to certificate
- May offer federal student aid (not loans)



Student Experience

- Enrolling in college courses for credit or audit
- Internships/work study
- Paid jobs (on/off campus)
- Campus Life/Organizations
- Learning to live independently





TPSID 2017-2018 AT A GLANCE

25 GRANTEES **48*** PROGRAMS **19** STATES



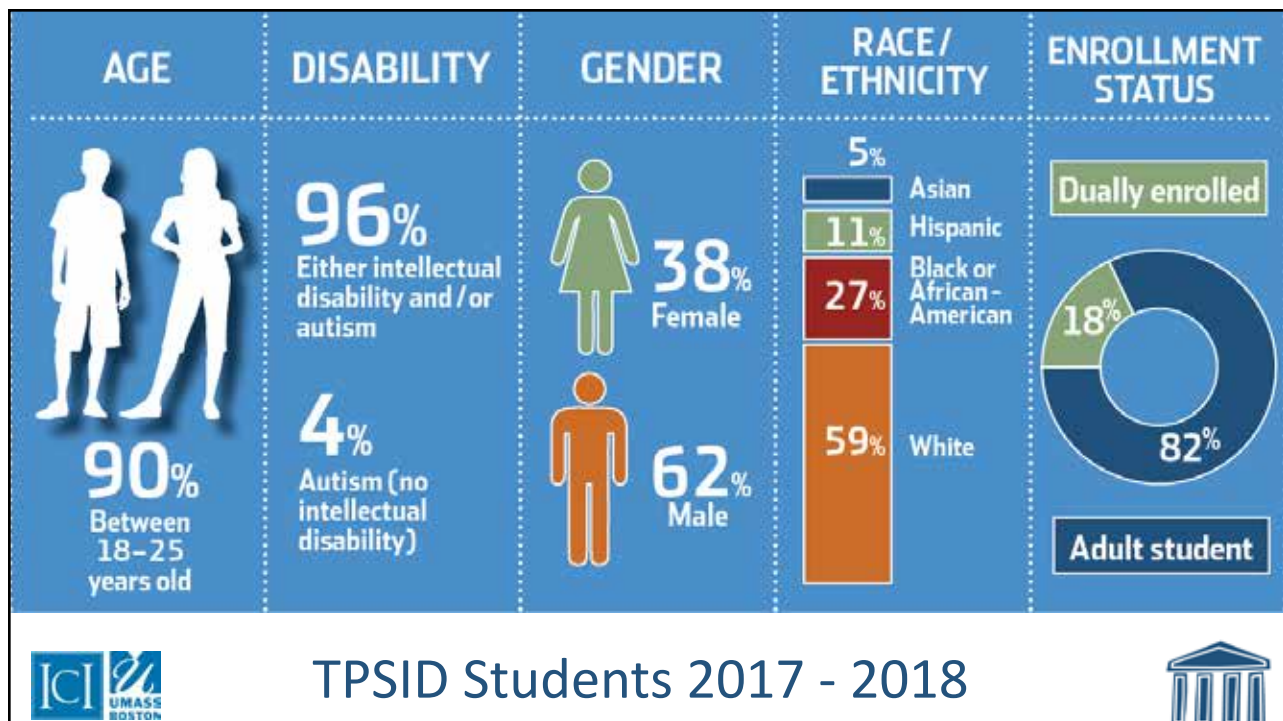
18 AVERAGE NUMBER OF STUDENTS PER PROGRAM

25 APPROVED COMPREHENSIVE TRANSITION PROGRAMS

21 SERVING DUALY ENROLLED STUDENTS



* at 46 IHE





ACADEMICS

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837 students



enrolled in

5,653 courses



for an average of

7 courses (inclusive or specialized)
per student per year.



ACADEMICS



**Average
number of
academically
inclusive
classes per
semester**



**Courses taken
for credit**



**Received
services from
Disability
Support
Services office**

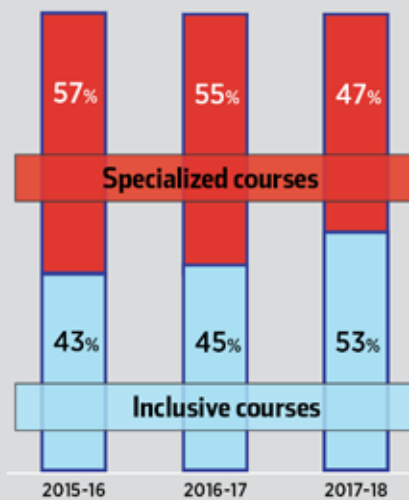


TPSID DATA 2017-2018



COURSE ACCESS

Inclusive vs. specialized course enrollments



TPSID Cohort Trend Data (2015-2018)

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.



Sample of Courses Attended by TPSID Students

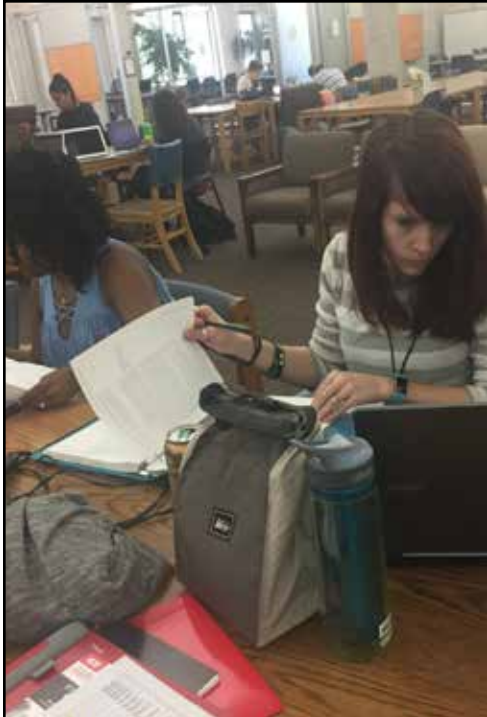
Academic: Beginning American Sign Language II, Fundamentals of Writing, Writing for Children, Introduction to Sociology, World Civilization II, Pre-Algebra, Careers in Healthcare, American History to 1877, Introduction to Psychology
 Business: Microcomputer Applications for Business, Principles of Advertising, Principles of Marketing, Principles of Management, Front Office Management, Hospitality Seminar
 Technology: Advanced Microcomputer Applications, Web Page Development I & II, Intermediate Photoshop
 Arts: Painting II, Ceramics I, Ballroom Dance, Latin Dance, Vocal Performance Workshop, Introduction to Watercolor, Write Your Life Story, Drawing I
 Career Exploration: Professional Etiquette, Keys to Effective Communication, Criminal Procedure, Strategies for College and Career, Sanitation & Safety, Child Development, Response to Terrorism, Making Movies, Introduction to Mass Media, Career/Life Planning
 Wellness: Personal Fitness, Introduction to Wellness, Swimming, Yoga I & II, Handling Medical Emergencies



KU TRANSITION TO
POSTSECONDARY
EDUCATION
The University of Kansas



Social Life
Club
Housing
Activities

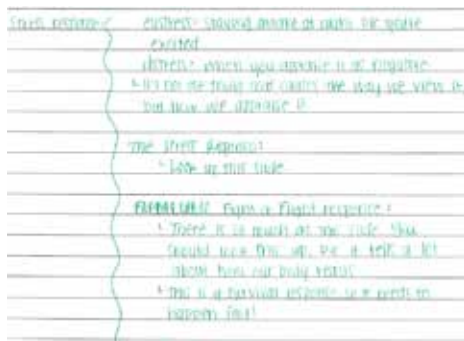


Inclusive Academics

- Preparation
 - Student – tutoring focused on learning strategies (not content) with peers
 - Instructor – UDL training; ongoing support
 - Other campus units (writing center, disability services office, etc.)
- Accommodations first
- Adaptations as needed for student/course
- Access to all undergraduate courses at KU
- 6 credit hours/semester (min)
- Career Internship each semester

Accommodation vs. Adaptation

Accommodation: Note-Taker



The **alteration of environment, curriculum format, or equipment** that allows an individual with a disability to **gain access to content and/or complete assigned tasks**. They allow students with disabilities to **pursue a regular course of study**.

Adapted from: <https://www.washington.edu/doit/what-difference-between-accommodation-and-modification-student-disability>

Adaptation: Guided Notes

The Stress Response

- All animals, including humans, have the ability to respond to emergencies they **perceive as** _____.
- The **sympathetic _____ system** [1/2 of the **Autonomic Nervous System (ANS)**] responds to activate the body to respond to a possible threat. This response is known as the "_____".
- The _____ ("_____ **or** _____ **response**") is a series of physiological changes that occur in the body.

Individualized **changes in the curriculum or how learning is evaluated**. Made for students with disabilities who may not be able to comprehend all of the **content in a course, or complete an assignment, participate, or take a test** at the level that is expected.

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EMPLOYMENT

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EMPLOYMENT



**Employed while
in college**



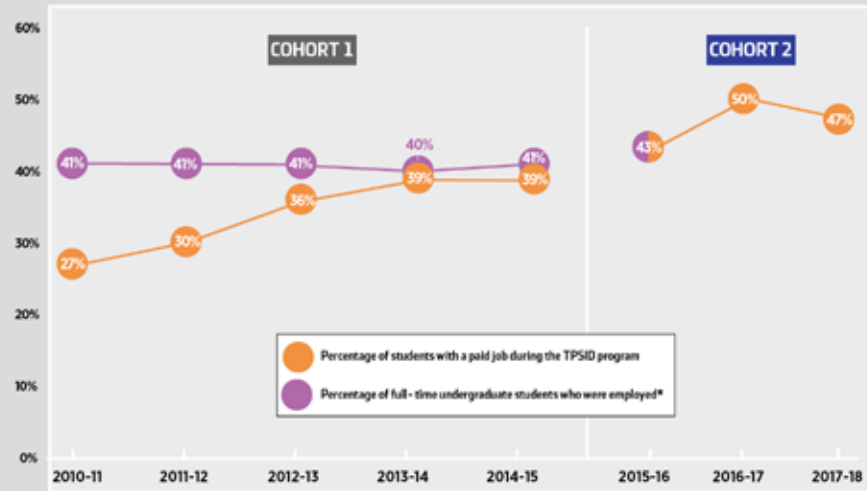
**Received
services from
Vocational
Rehabilitation**



**Never held a
paid job prior
to enrollment**



PAID EMPLOYMENT IN COLLEGE

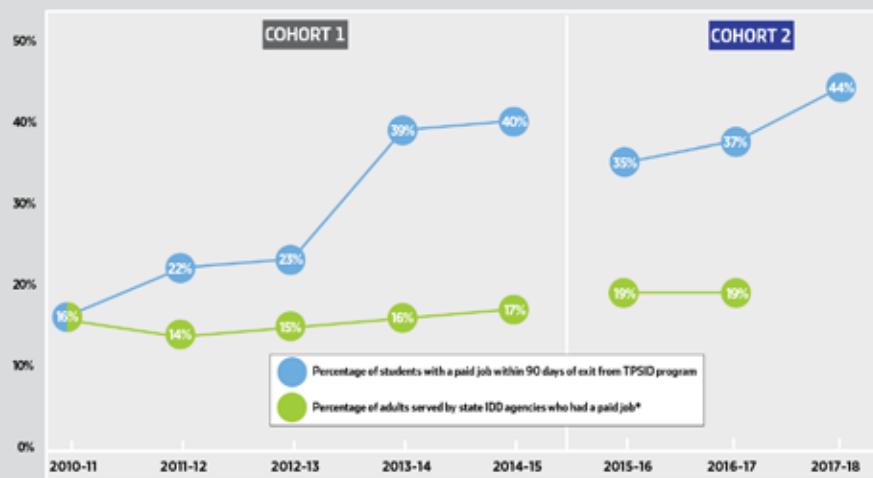


*National Center for Education Statistics

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.



PAID EMPLOYMENT AT EXIT



*National Core Indicators

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.



Career Development/Employment

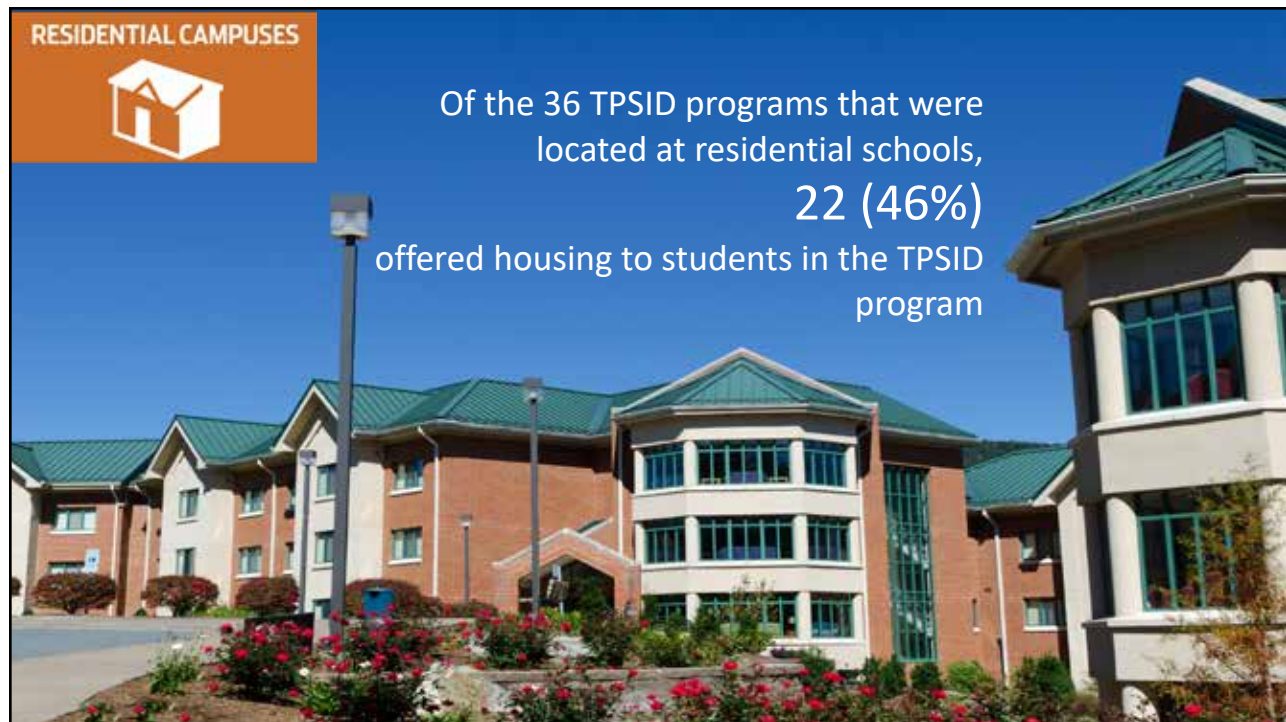
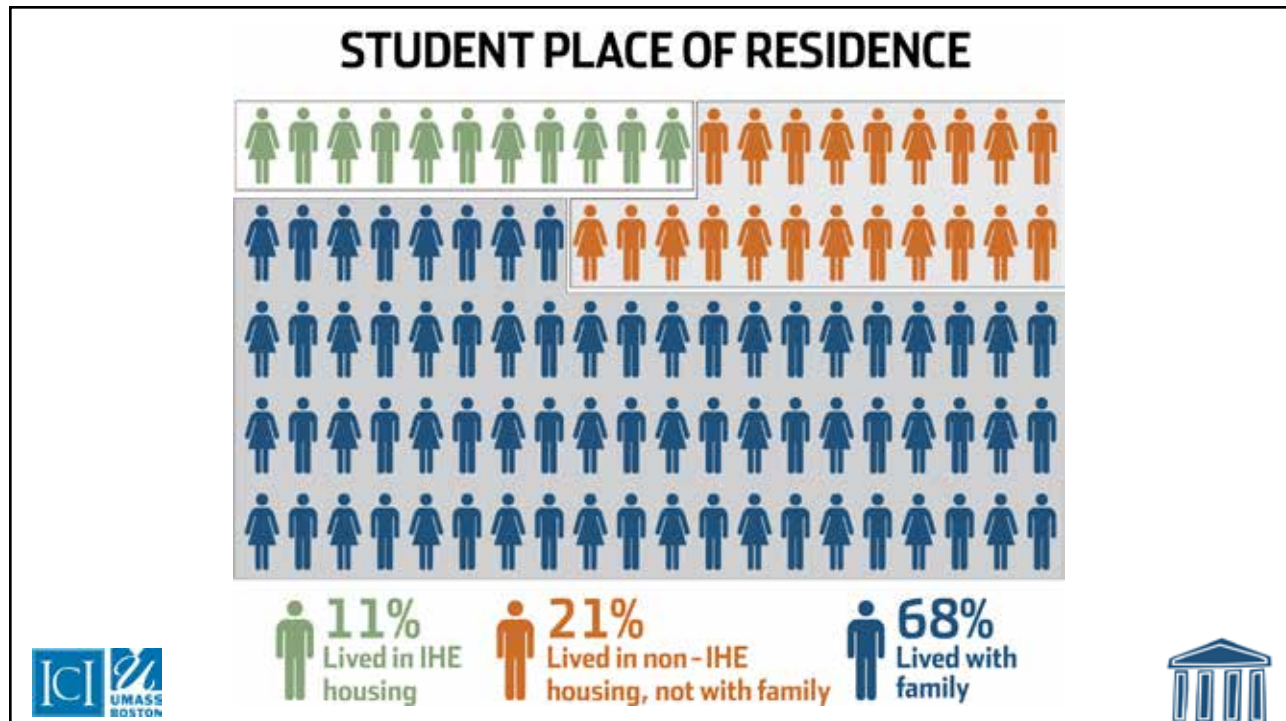


- Career development focus
- Student paid jobs
- Career internships (paid/unpaid)
- Semester 1 – resume, career assessment, informational interview, job shadow, interview practice
- Sem 2-4 – internships
- Coursework aligns w/career focus
- EPSY210



STUDENT LIFE

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CAMPUS ENGAGEMENT



**of programs
engaged
students in
campus
organizations**



**of programs
supported
students to
participate in
campus social
events**



TPSID DATA 2017-2018



Blazing Trails

Life isn't about finding yourself. Life is about creating yourself.

George Bernard Shaw



***Life is 10% what happens to you
and 90% how you react to it.***

Charles R. Swindoll

Student Life (everything else!)

- Campus housing is optional – TPE trains housing staff & meets every other week w/CD
- Connecting to peers
 - Formal – clubs & organizations
 - Informal – finding hang-out spots; learning to invite others; having resources to do it (note cards, text on phones)
 - Using phone technology (GroupMe)
 - Attending activities of interest – never as a structured group
- Grease on the Wheels – paid peer mentors
- Preparing the environment/club/organization



TRANSITION IMPLICATIONS

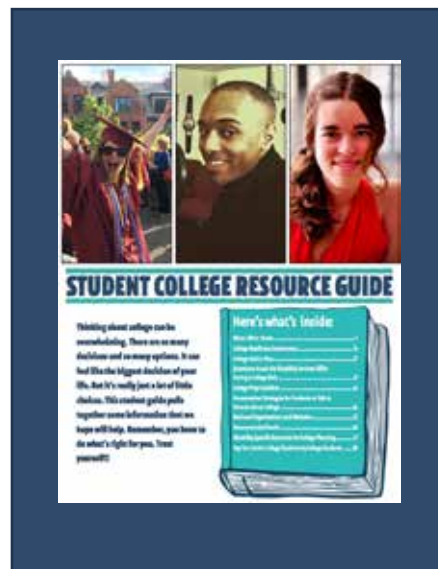


What messages are students are hearing?

- Students with bad grades can't go to college
- Students with behavior issues can't go to college
- Only wealthy students can go to college
- The only way I can go to college is to go full time or move far away



Student Resource Guide



FREE

<https://thinkcollege.net/sites/default/files/files/resources/FinalStudentResourceGuide.pdf>



Our Professional Capacity

- Do we know all current college options?
- Do we share it with parents/students in a meaningful way?
- Are ALL students included in college search and preparation activities?
- Do ALL students with disability get access to the HS counselor?



Who gets what information?

Transition Fair

- Community Rehabilitation Providers
- Employment Supports
- Social service agencies
- Vocational Rehabilitation
- Special education staff
- Transition Staff

College Fair

- Community colleges
- Universities
- Career and technical colleges
- Certificate programs
- For profit universities
- Online colleges
- Financial Aid info Sessions



Levels of Learning in College

- Acclimation and exposure-how to navigate adult learning
- Content/Interest-interested in art history, computers, theater and want to know more
- Applied content- I want to become a certified vet tech and need to pass this class



Ensure College is evident in IEP

Measurable postsecondary goal: Education and training

After graduation, Juan will attend a college or university to pursue education in support of his chosen career path.

IEP goals

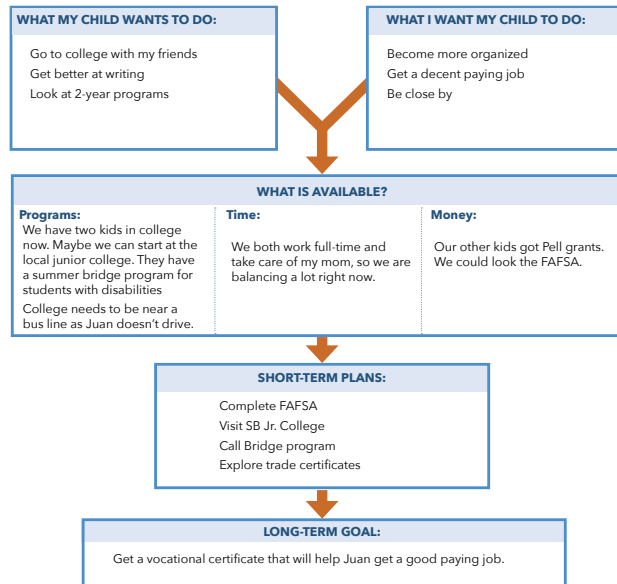
Using online resources, Juan will identify a minimum of 3 potential careers that match his interests and strengths, and will be able to state the educational requirements for those careers.

Transition services and activities

- Self-advocacy skills instruction
- Research and visit colleges and universities that have programs in areas that match potential careers
- Attend college fair
- Participate in extra-curricular activities
- Provide information on financial support for college
- Make a plan for paying for college



College Mapping Tool



The Ultimate College Outcomes

- Being a consumer of your education instead of a passive recipient
- Viewing the acquisition of knowledge as a desirable experience
- Connecting learning to real outcomes





**LET'S KEEP
IN TOUCH**

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thinkcollegeTA@gmail.com

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